FOR FAMILIES · FREE FAMILY COMPANION

Ten minutes together: *What Is God Like?*

A companion to our short film, ready to use tonight. You don't need to prepare anything. Just sit together, press play and follow the steps below.

2 min	**Watch** the film together
1 min	**Read** Mark 6:34
4 min	**Talk** about two questions
1 min	**Pray**, if you'd like to
2 min	**Plan** one thing to try this week

1 · WATCH · 2 MINUTES

Press play together

Watch *What Is God Like?* on YouTube (1 minute 51 seconds). Sit where you can both see the screen. Afterwards, wait a moment before anyone talks.

Find it on YouTube: search "Beloved Meadow What Is God Like", or go to youtube.com/watch?v=0sQ-YYJqn94

2 · READ · 1 MINUTE

What Jesus felt when he saw a crowd

Read this verse aloud slowly. Then read it again.

> [34] Jesus came out, saw a great multitude, and he had compassion on them, because they were like sheep without a shepherd, and he began to teach them many things.
>
> Mark 6:34, World English Bible. *Multitude* means a big crowd. *Compassion* means a deep, kind ache to help.

Jesus had been trying to get some rest. Instead, a huge crowd was waiting for him. He didn't sigh or send them away. He looked at them, felt compassion for them and began to teach them. When we want to know what God is like, we can look at Jesus.

3 · TALK · 4 MINUTES

Two questions

There is more than one good answer to both questions. Take turns, and let the grown-up answer too.

1. What's one thing the film showed you about God? Was there anything new, or anything you already knew?

Leave a pause. Then try: "Tell me more about that."

2. Jesus looked at the crowd and felt compassion. When Jesus looks at you, what do you think he feels?

Some children will say "happy", some "sad for me", some "I don't know". All of those are honest answers.

For the grown-up: listen more than you explain. If your child's idea of God sounds stern or far away, don't argue. Ask, "What makes you think that?", and then go back to the verse: "Here's what Jesus felt when he looked at people." You don't have to finish the conversation tonight.

Younger children might answer by pointing at a moment in the film or drawing it. **Older children** can try a follow-up question: "Is there anything about God you find hard to understand?"

4 · PRAY · 1 MINUTE · OPTIONAL

A short prayer

Anyone can pray aloud, pray in their own words, pray silently or just listen. You could say this together:

> Jesus, thank you that you see us and care for us, like a shepherd cares for sheep. Help us know what God is like by getting to know you. Amen.

5 · TRY TOGETHER · 2 MINUTES

The kindness lookout

Before you finish, agree on this: tomorrow, each of you will look out for **one moment when someone cares for someone else**. It might be a friend sharing, a stranger holding a door or a teacher helping.

At dinner or bedtime tomorrow, tell each other what you saw. Then wonder together: *"How is that a little bit like Jesus?"*
